

AMBER ESOL · USER MANUAL

Amber Getting Started Guide

A step-by-step guide with pictures from the real system. Written to be read by learners — simple words, short steps.

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Amber ESOL Getting Started Guide

This chapter is for everyone. It explains what Amber is, how to sign in, how to find your way around, how the platform speaks your language, and what every specialist term in the other chapters means. Read it once, then keep it nearby as the glossary.

The idea in one line: Amber is an AI supported English learning platform where learners practise with an AI tutor, teachers focus on the learners who need a human, and the paperwork that funded provision requires writes itself as evidence, honestly, in the background.

1. What Amber is

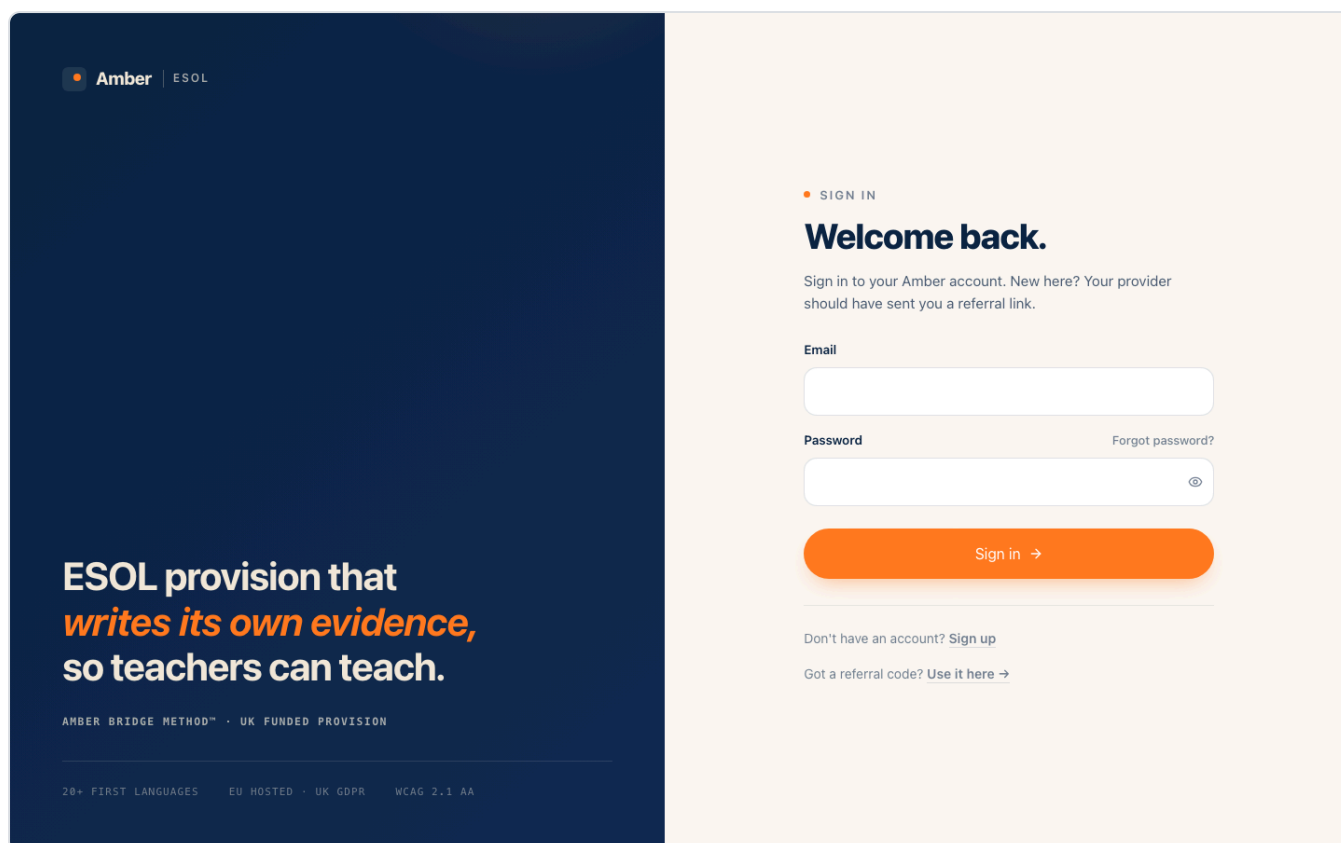
Amber ESOL is a platform for councils, colleges, and charities that run funded English courses for adults whose first language is not English. Learners practise real life scenarios with an AI tutor that supports them in their own language. The platform records progress and hours automatically, in the exact shape that UK funding rules expect, and keeps a person in charge of every judgement that matters.

Four kinds of people use it, and each has their own guide:

Role	Who they are	Where they land after sign in	Their guide
Learner	An adult learning English with their provider	Their learning home page	Learner Guide
Teacher	An ESOL teacher working across learners	The teacher dashboard and priority queue	Teacher Guide
Org admin	The provider's administrator	The organisation dashboard	Org Admin Guide
Amber admin	Amber's own platform staff	The platform overview	Platform Admin Guide

2. Signing in and out

How to get here: open the platform and press **Sign in**, or go straight to the login page.



Step by step

1. Enter your email and password. The eye button shows the password while you check it.
2. Press **Sign in**. You land on the home screen for your role, and if you were sent to sign in from a deeper page, you return to that page instead.

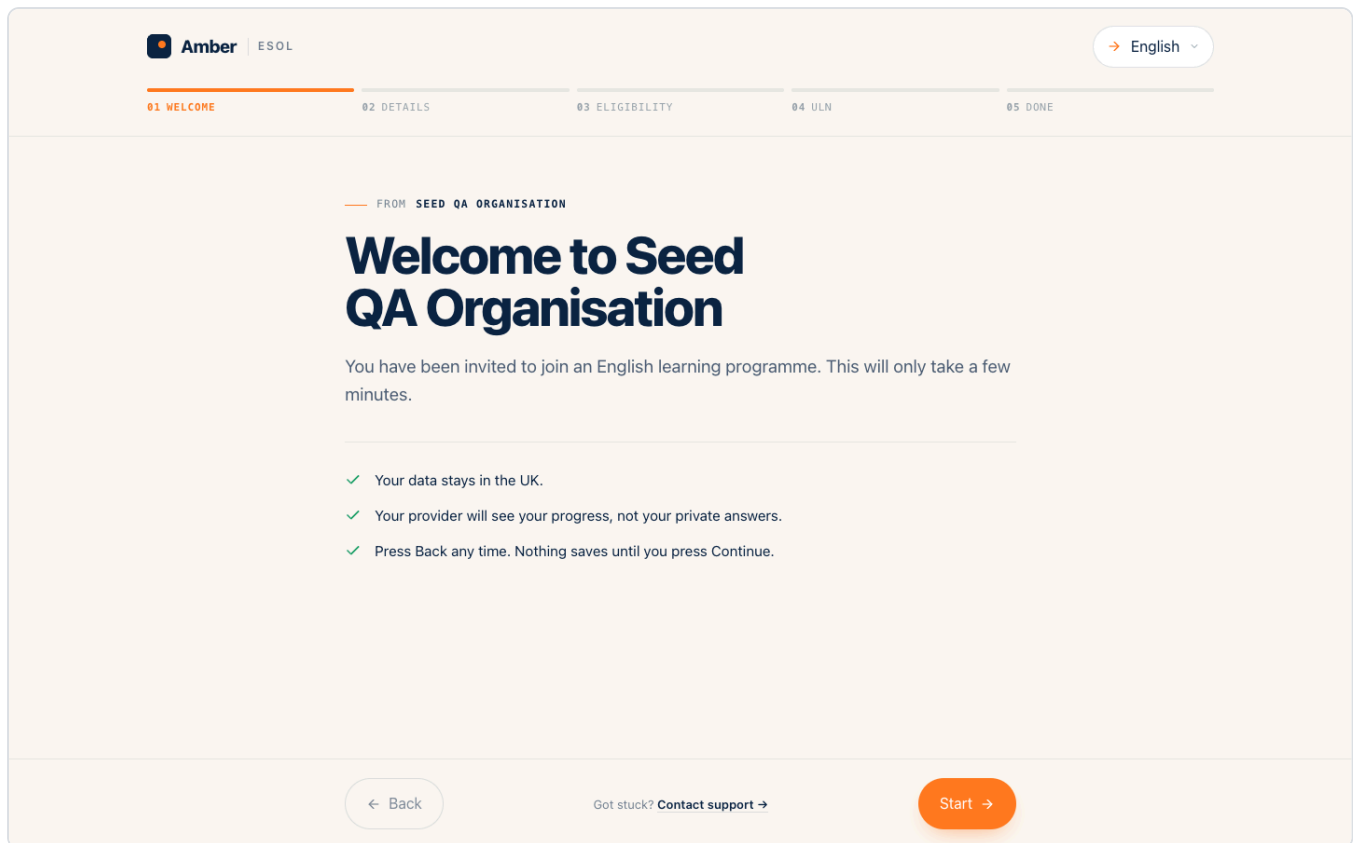
If the password is wrong you see "Invalid email or password". The message is deliberately the same whether the email or the password was the problem, so nobody can use the login page to discover which emails have accounts.

Forgot your password? Press the **Forgot password?** link, enter your email, and check your inbox. The page always says the same thing, "If an account exists for that email, the link is on its way", for the same privacy reason. The link in the email works once and expires after one hour. The reset page asks for a new password of at least 8 characters including an uppercase letter, a number, and a symbol, and shows a strength meter while you type.

Staying signed in. You stay signed in for up to 7 days on the same browser. After long enough away, the platform asks you to sign in again and then returns you to the page you were on.

Signing out. Open the profile menu at the top right, or scroll to the bottom of the menu on a phone, and press **Sign out**.

Good to know: learners do not create their own accounts from the login page. Learners join through an invitation link sent by their organisation, which opens a short wizard in their own language and ends in the placement assessment. The invitation screen looks like this, with the language picker in the top corner:

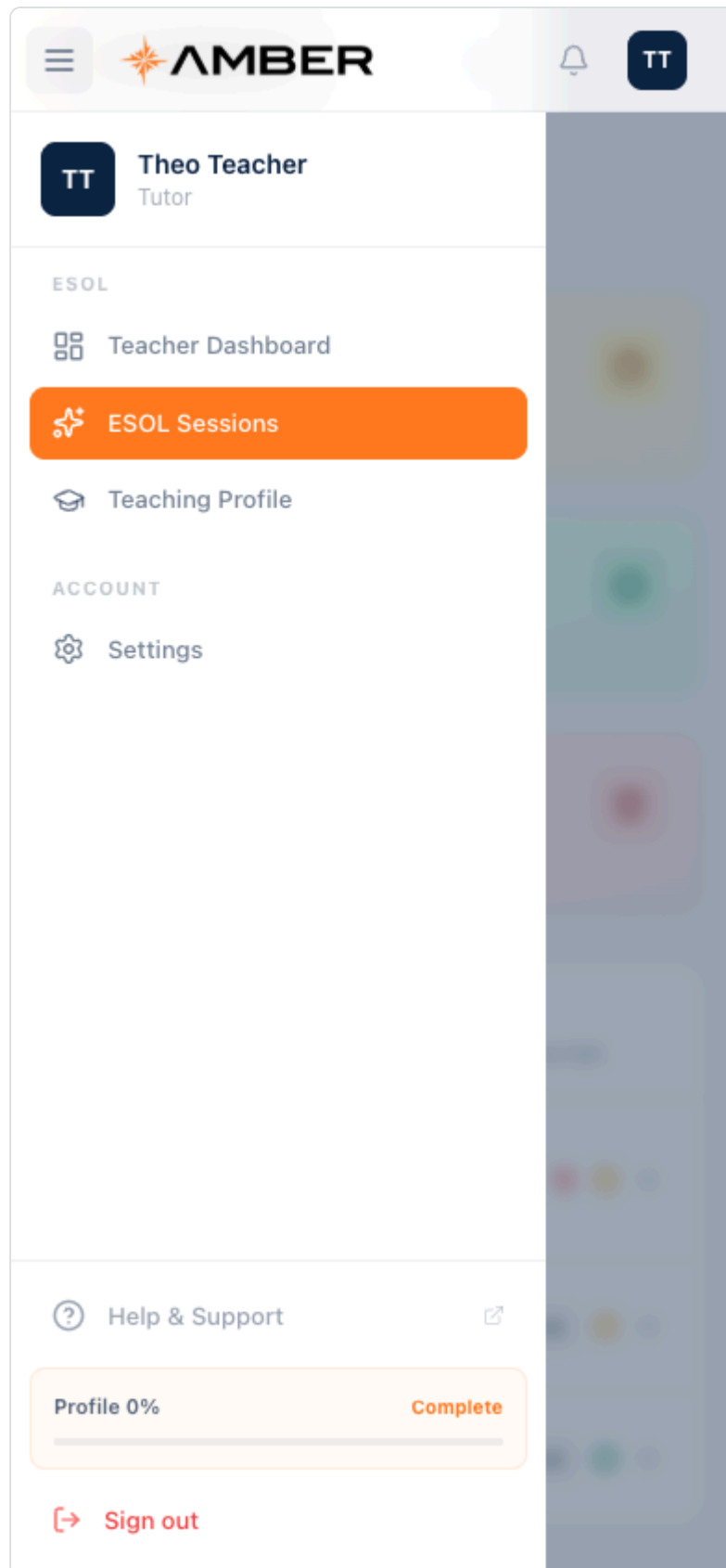


3. Finding your way around

Every role uses the same shell:

- **The sidebar** on the left lists your screens, grouped under small headings. Press **Collapse** at the bottom to shrink it. Your profile card and the **Help and Support** link live at the bottom of the sidebar.
- **The breadcrumb** across the top always shows where you are.
- **The header icons** at the top right are help, notifications (the bell), and your profile menu.

On a phone, the sidebar becomes a drawer behind the menu button at the top left. Everything is in the same order, with **Sign out** at the bottom:

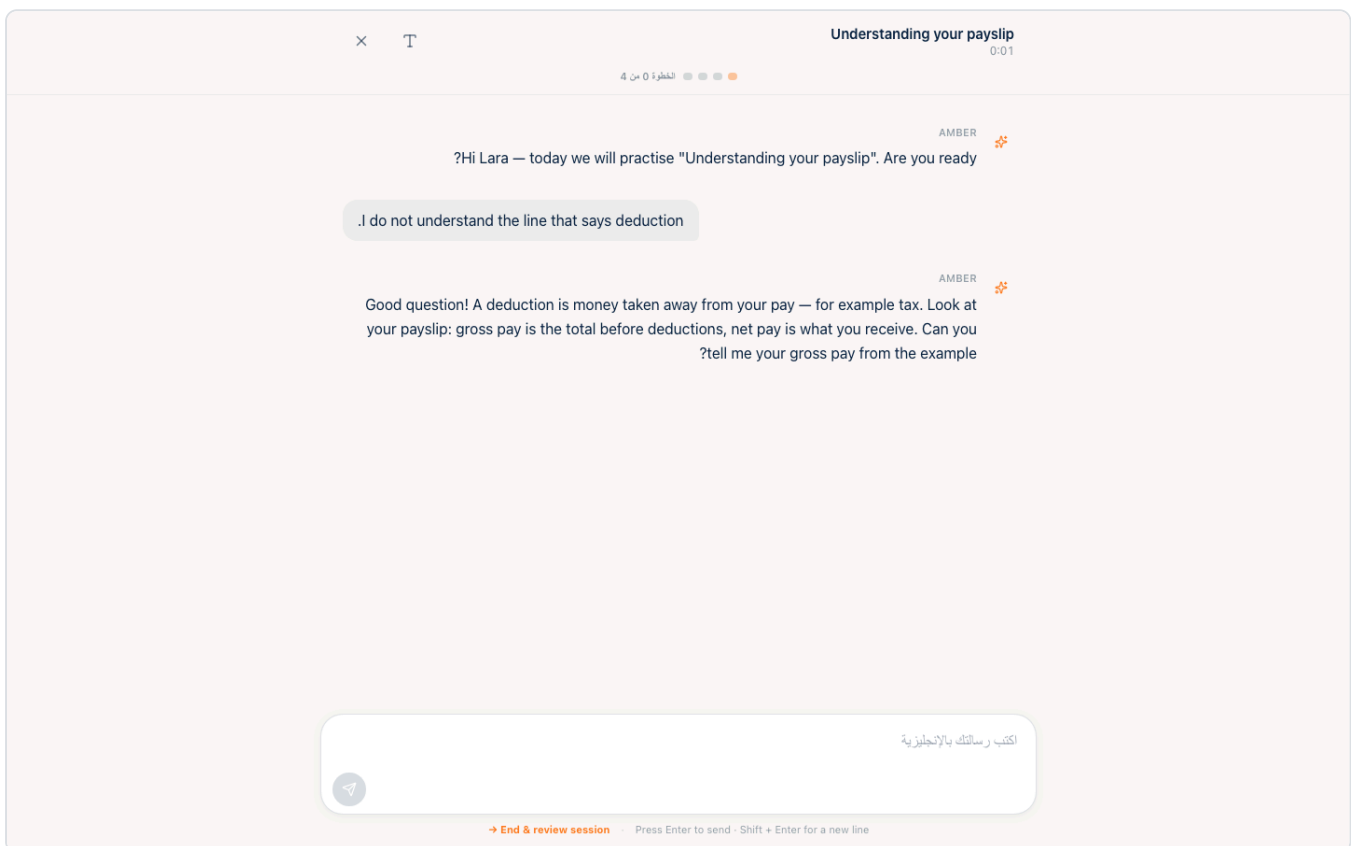


Every screen in the platform works at phone size. Tables scroll sideways inside their cards rather than breaking the page.

4. Your language, and right to left

Amber is built for people learning English, so the platform never assumes English.

- **Choosing a language.** The language picker sits in the top corner of the invitation wizard. A learner picks their language on their very first screen, before anything else, and the choice is remembered on that device. Four languages are selectable today, English, Arabic, Cantonese, and Turkish, with sixteen more already prepared behind the scenes.
- **What follows the choice.** The placement assessment, the session preparation screens, the practice session itself, goal setting, and the messages inbox all follow the chosen language.
- **Right to left.** Arabic flips the whole layout so it reads naturally right to left, as here mid session:

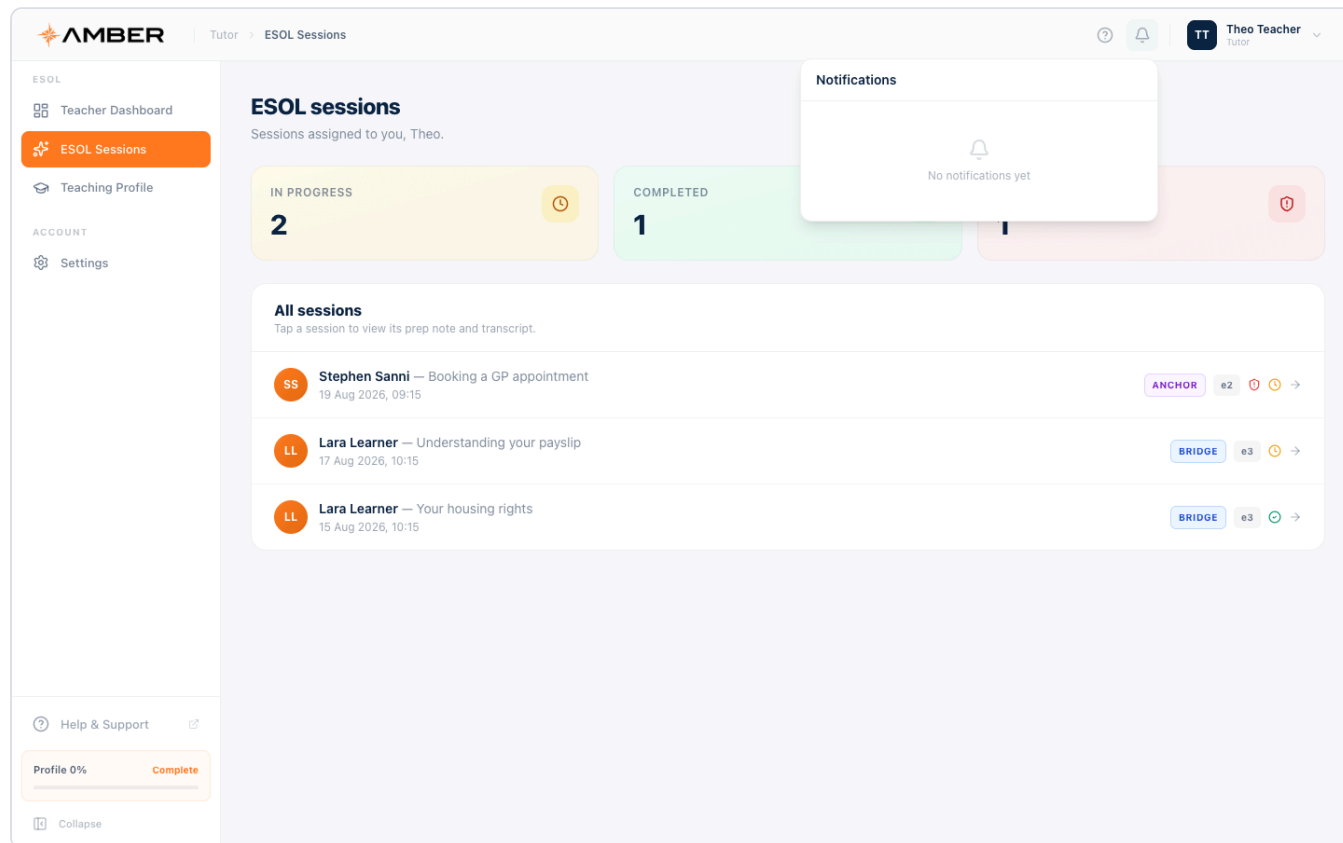


- **Messages arrive translated.** When a teacher writes to a learner, the platform translates the message into the learner's first language before it is delivered, and the teacher sees a preview of that translation before sending.
- **Crisis messages too.** The supportive messages a learner sees if they disclose something worrying are written by people, per language, in advance. They are never machine generated in the moment.

Good to know: the learner's first language also shapes the teaching itself. The AI tutor uses it as a scaffold into English, more support at Entry 1, almost none by Level 2. That approach is the Bridge Method, explained in the glossary below.

5. How the platform talks to you

The bell. Every role has the notifications bell in the header. It shows an orange badge with your unread count, and opens into the ten newest notifications. Press one to mark it read, or **Mark all read**. The list refreshes itself about once a minute.



Toasts. Small cards appear at the top right after actions, to confirm a save, a send, or to explain a failure. They disappear on their own.

For learners, teacher messages cannot be missed. A message from your teacher appears as a banner on your home page, as a note that opens when you arrive, and as a full screen note before your next practice session begins. Messages marked **Auto sent** are friendly automatic check ins that go out on the teacher's behalf when someone has been away a while; teachers can switch those off.

Email. The platform sends email for the moments that matter: safeguarding alerts go to the safeguarding lead within seconds, organisations can send a one tap encouragement email in the learner's own language, and admins are emailed when a learner is ready to move up a level. Teacher messages currently live in the app only, there is no email copy, so the in app surfaces above are the ones to trust.

6. Accessibility

The platform is built to the WCAG 2.1 AA standard, and the practical things you will notice are these:

- **Touch targets** are at least 44 pixels, so buttons are easy to hit on a phone.

- **Form fields never zoom the page** on iPhones, because text inputs are always at least 16 pixels.
- **Keyboard use** works across the platform, with a visible focus ring as you tab.
- **Text size in sessions.** The practice session has its own text size button that cycles small, medium, and large, for the screen where reading comfort matters most.
- **Listen and speak.** Where voice is enabled, learners can press **Listen** to hear the tutor's message aloud, and opt in to a microphone to speak their answers instead of typing.
- **Screens work small.** Learner pages are usable at 425 pixels wide, and the practice session at 375 pixels.

Accessibility work is ongoing; some older administrative screens are still being brought up to the same bar.

7. If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
I cannot sign in	Check the email and password. After a reset link expires (one hour), request a new one.
My invitation link says it is invalid or expired	Links expire after 30 days by default. Ask your organisation for a fresh one.
I did not get the reset email	The page will not confirm whether the email has an account; check spam, then ask your admin to confirm the address on file.
It signed me out by itself	You were away long enough for the session to end. Sign in again and you return to where you were.
The page looks stuck loading	Give it a few seconds; most screens show grey placeholder blocks while data loads.
The layout looks wrong in Arabic	Tell your provider which screen; the direction flip is per screen and feedback pinpoints the fix.

Glossary

The other four guides use these terms freely. Plain English versions of all of them live [here](#).

Levels and assessment

ESOL. English for Speakers of Other Languages, the UK term for English courses taught to adults whose first language is not English.

E1, E2, E3, L1, L2. The five UK adult ESOL course levels: Entry 1, Entry 2, Entry 3, Level 1, and Level 2. Entry 1 is the beginner stage and Level 2 is the most advanced the platform teaches. Every learner, session, and result carries one of these levels.

CEFR. The Common European Framework of Reference for Languages, an international scale of language ability. Amber maps the UK levels onto it: E1 is A1, E2 sits between A1 and A2, E3 is A2, L1 is B1, and L2 is B2.

Placement assessment. The 20 question assessment every learner takes when joining. It adapts once, after the fifth answer, rewriting the remaining questions to suit the learner, then places them at one of the five levels with a confidence score. A teacher reviews every placement result.

Funding and compliance

ILR. Individualised Learner Record, the standard data return that funded UK education providers submit to government. Amber builds the ILR rows automatically from real learner and session records.

ULN. Unique Learner Number, a ten digit identifier that follows a learner across UK education systems. It is the key identity field on funding returns.

ESFA. The Education and Skills Funding Agency, the government body that receives ILR submissions.

ASF. The Adult Skills Fund, the pot of government funding that pays for adult courses such as ESOL. Amber records hours and evidence in the shape ASF assurance reviews expect, and keeps records for at least six years.

GLH. Guided Learning Hours, the taught hours recorded for each learner, which funding claims are based on. Amber totals them automatically from AI tutor time, teacher contact time, and any hours imported from before the platform.

Total versus Claimable GLH. Two figures shown side by side everywhere hours appear. Total GLH counts everything including AI tutor time. Claimable GLH excludes AI time and counts only teacher contact and imported hours, because AI hours are not yet an accepted basis for a funding claim. Any funding figure must use the claimable number.

Teacher contact target. The funding model assumes teacher contact sits between 10 and 20 percent of a learner's total hours. Below that there is too little qualified oversight; above it the cost advantage of the AI tutor erodes. The platform tracks the ratio and flags drift.

MIS. Management information system, the student record software a provider already runs, such as ProSolution, Maytas, or EBS. Amber can push learner records into it so nothing is typed twice.

Evidence chain. The audit trail that links every claim about a learner back to the moment its evidence was created. Records are written as events happen and can never be edited afterwards, and an AI judgement only counts as final once a person confirms it.

RARPA, the progress framework

RARPA. Recognising And Recording Progress And Achievement, the six stage quality framework used to evidence learner progress on courses that do not end in an exam. Amber generates the evidence for each stage automatically from real activity.

- **Stage 1, aims.** Who the learner is and what the course sets out to achieve.

- **Stage 2, starting point.** The diagnostic assessment recorded at enrolment, so later progress has a baseline.
- **Stage 3, objectives.** Individual learning objectives agreed with the learner, in their own language, with the agreement itself recorded as evidence.
- **Stage 4, ongoing progress.** The running record collected every session: scores, vocabulary, skills practised, and how the learner responds to correction.
- **Stage 5, the achievement review.** The end of level review. It gathers the learner's self assessment, the AI tutor's summary, and then two human approvals.
- **Stage 6, next steps.** Where the learner goes after the course, always confirmed by a person.

The Stage 5 two person rule. A level achievement is only final after two different people approve it in order: the teacher signs off first, then the org admin confirms. Both approvals are stamped with who and when. Nothing the AI scores can become an achievement on its own.

The teaching method

Bridge Method. Amber's teaching approach: the learner's first language is used as a scaffold into English rather than being banned. The share of first language is set by level, from roughly 70 percent at Entry 1 down to almost none at Level 2, and it reduces as confidence grows.

ANCHOR, BRIDGE, IMMERSION. The three modes a practice session moves between, decided turn by turn. ANCHOR gives maximum first language support and switches on when the learner is struggling or distressed. BRIDGE is the normal mix for the learner's level. IMMERSION is mostly or entirely English, earned by three strong answers in a row. The platform never records less support than the learner actually needed.

Vocab ledger. The per learner record of every word met, with a count of encounters. A word counts as retained once the learner has met it at least 5 times and produced it correctly in a strong answer, and once retained it stays retained. Teachers see the ledger split into retained and in progress.

Priority bands P1 to P4. The flag that tells teachers who needs attention first, recalculated daily. P1 means act now, for example an open safeguarding alert, two weeks of silence, or three weak sessions in a row. P2 means act within a week. P3 means act within two weeks. P4 means on track, nothing needed.

Safety

DSL. Designated Safeguarding Lead, the named person responsible for acting on safeguarding concerns. When the platform detects a possible disclosure during a session it alerts the DSL by email within seconds, while the learner immediately sees a supportive, human written message with real helplines. The platform never handles the concern inside the lesson and never decides on its own; a person always does.

You are ready. Pick your guide: *Learner*, *Teacher*, *Org Admin*, or *Platform Admin*.